

GTX 550Ti Shootout

Read our detailed comparison of these cards on www.thinkdigit.com. Go to <http://bit.ly/i3dYwY>

Did you know?

The Catalyst 11.4 Early Preview driver from AMD is supposed to offer a 12 to 70 % performance boost in 6800 cards. Get it from: <http://bit.ly/dSrerk>

Bazaar mini

GRAPHICS CARD



ZOTAC GTX 550 Ti AMP! Edition

Price: ₹9,990



Palit GTX 550 Ti Sonic

Price: ₹9,490



MSI N550GTX-Ti Cyclone II

Price : ₹9,700



MSI R6850 Cyclone Power Edition

Price : ₹13,500

SPECIFICATIONS

Core clock.....1000 MHz
Memory Clock.....1100 MHz
Memory Interface.....192-bit
Cuda Cores.....192

Core clock.....1000 MHz
Memory Clock.....1100 MHz
Memory Interface.....192-bit
Cuda Cores.....192

Core clock.....950 MHz
Memory Clock.....1026 MHz
Memory Interface.....192-bit
Cuda Cores.....192

Core clock.....860 MHz
Memory Clock.....1100 MHz
Memory Interface.....256-bit
Stream Processors.....960

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features.....7.0
Factory overclocked core clock by 100 MHz and memory clock by 74 MHz.

Performance7.5
The fastest performer amongst the GTX 550 Ti cards though by only a small margin. FarCry 2 (1280x1024, Ultra High, 4xAA): 81.43 FPS. Load temp: 65 degrees.

Build quality7.5
Sturdily built exactly like the GTX 560Ti we'd reviewed sometime back.

Value for money.....6.5
The most expensive amongst the GTX 550 Ti's we received.

Features.....7.0
Exactly the same overclock speed as the ZOTAC card. Comes with a DVI, HDMI and a VGA port

Performance7.5
Overall performance is just about 0.19 percent lesser than the ZOTAC card. FarCry 2 (1280x1024, Ultra High, 4xAA): 81.5 FPS. Load temp: 67 degrees.

Build quality7.0
Not much to complain about the build quality. The card is airy enough.

Value for money.....7.5
The most value for money of the three GTX 550 Ti cards.

Features.....6.5
Not as souped up as the other two 550Ti cards here. Core clock is upped by only 50 MHz.

Performance7.0
The MSI 550 Ti is clocked lower and hence performs a little less. FarCry 2 (1280x1024, Ultra High, 4xAA): 78.32 FPS. Load temp: 45 degrees.

Build Quality.....7.5
Flamboyant, with it's Cyclone heat sink and the propeller blade inspired design.

Value for money.....6.5
We'd give this one a slightly lower score on this parameter.

Features.....7.0
Factory overclocked by 85 MHz on the core clock and 100MHz on memory clock.

Performance7.0
The performance is impressive - FarCry 2 (1280x1024, Ultra High, 4xAA): 85.29, 1920x1080: 78.32. The card is at par with GTX 460s we've tested before.

Build Quality.....7.5
Cyclone heat sink attempts to dissipate heat via two heat pipes enclosed in fins. Good build.

Value for money.....7.0
For a HD 6850 this card is priced a little on the higher side.

WE SAY

7.0

The GTX 550 Ti is built around the GF116 chip which first debuted as the GF106 chip for the GTS 450. The card looks snazzy and very much like the 560 Ti AMP. They are architecturally the same, but the difference between the two is that for the GTX 550 Ti, it's fully unlocked in terms of ROPs, and memory controllers. You now get a higher clock, higher RAM and enhanced memory interface over the GTS 450. The ZOTAC GTX 550 Ti is a good performer with a slight premium on price. It comes with 2 DVI ports, an HDMI port and oddly enough a display port.

7.0

This is quite an overclocked card and hence expectedly gives good performance. It returned a 3D Mark Vantage overall score of 13601 and a GPU score of 10965. We can safely say that the ZOTAC and Palit cards are almost exactly the same since they're factory overclocked to the same extent. Yet this one is a little cheaper and hence the most value for money GTX 550 Ti. In terms of construction, looks are a little kiddish though. Among the three GTX 550Ti's featured here Palit GTX 550 Ti Sonic emerged as the best value for money card.

6.5

One of the most important factors about this card was that it ran considerably cooler; about 10 degrees. The other two in the race, ZOTAC 550 Ti Amp, and Palit 550 Ti Sonic being more overclocked were hotter clocking 65 to 67 degrees at peak load. Considering the MSI card ran cooler by quite a large margin, it wouldn't be too much of a stretch to imagine overclocking it a great deal. Especially since Afterburner, MSI's overclocking utility, came bundled with it. The fan is supposed to be propeller blade inspired resulting in 20 percent more airflow.

7.0

The card obviously whoops the GTX 550 Ti's featured alongside. We got a 3D Mark Vantage overall score of 15440 and a GPU score of 14388. But then this card is more in the league of GTX 460s. This particular release of the HD 6850 bears the Power Edition tag. This means that by using the MSI Afterburner overclocking tool you'll be able to raise not just core voltage but also up the Memory and AUX voltage. Although priced on the higher side, the factory overclock, fancy cooling, and being a power edition may just about justify the price.